

Bobby Flennoy

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UX RESEARCHER & AI ENGINEER | CS @ UTA

I study how people interact with AI so we can build tools they actually trust. By combining Computer Science with Cognitive Neuroscience, I bridge the gap between complex engineering and human behavior.

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Cognitive Neuroscience

Aug. 2021 – Aug. 2026

Arlington, TX

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **User Research:** Moderated Interviews, Usability Testing, Participant Recruiting, Journey Mapping, Surveys.
- **AI & Perception:** Human-AI Workflows, Trust Analysis, Sentiment Analysis, HITL (Human-in-the-loop) Design.
- **Tools & Analysis:** MaxDiff Analysis, SQL, Python, Figma (Prototyping), UserTesting, Next.js, Dovetail.

EXPERIENCE

UX Research Intern

CBRE

Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

Richardson, TX

- **Global Research:** Ran research sessions with users across the globe, using **MaxDiff analysis on 500+ people** to find out which features actually mattered for managing complex facilities.
- **Rapid Validation:** Cut the time between finding a problem and testing a fix by **50%**. I did this by building AI-driven prototypes and testing them live during interviews to see if users trusted the results.
- **Cross-Team Strategy:** Worked directly with Designers and Engineers to turn interview notes into clear, technical goals for the product roadmap.

Product Researcher & Developer

Pearl Discovery (Non-Profit)

Mar. 2026 – Present

Remote

- **User Personas:** Led research on how different types of students and teachers use AI-categorization tools, focusing on where they feel the AI is helpful versus where it gets in the way.
- **Trust-Centered Design:** Built a **HITL (Human-in-the-loop) interface** to see how much control users need over automated data. I used their direct feedback to redesign the software to be more intuitive.
- **Performance Impact:** Turned massive amounts of interaction data into clear design changes that reduced the mental effort needed to use the platform by **90%**.

HCI Researcher

Hybrid Atelier Lab (University of Texas at Arlington)

May 2024 – Aug. 2024

Arlington, TX

- **Creative AI:** Investigated how GenAI changes the way people design and build things in 3D. I used lab studies and interviews to find out if AI helps or hurts a designer's creativity.
- **Iterative Testing:** Built functional React prototypes based on my research findings to test how users actually click, scroll, and build when paired with an AI assistant.

PROJECTS

AI-Copilot for Research Workflows

- **The Problem:** Qualitative research creates mountains of notes and transcripts that take days to organize and summarize.
- **The Fix:** Built an AI assistant that handles real-time transcription and script tracking. It includes a "pattern-finding" layer that generates live summaries, letting researchers focus on the person they are interviewing rather than their notes.

Neural Alignment & User Perception (TRIBE v2)

- **The Problem:** AI models often "guess" how a person is feeling based on text, but that doesn't always match the actual emotional response in the brain.
- **The Research:** Built a pipeline to compare predicted brain activity against emotional models to find where AI and human perception don't match up.

EXTRACURRICULAR

President: Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)

1st Place: HackUTD (NorthMark Cloud & Compute Challenge)

Creative Director: HackUTA

Aug. 2023 – Present

Nov. 2025

Aug. 2023 – Dec. 2025